

Absolutely — **raw** is a very worthwhile polysemy target because its meanings spread across **food, materials, natural ability, information/data, physical irritation, emotion, weather, inexperience, and several fixed professional compounds**.

I'm applying the same Golden Manual method: check literal and figurative meanings, domain uses, compounds, related forms, and then merge branches that still share the same underlying concept.

The manuals govern the curation method; the specific meanings below are standard modern-English analysis.

Word family: **raw / rawer / rawest / rawness**

Base word: raw

Comparative: rawer

Superlative: rawest

Related noun: rawness

Useful compounds / expressions: raw talent, raw speed, raw ability, raw material, raw materials, raw data, raw score, raw footage, raw image, raw file, raw meat, raw food, raw vegetables, raw milk, raw sewage, raw emotion, raw power, raw energy, raw nerve, raw deal

Part of speech: adjective / noun-related uses in compounds

Your sentence

> "...where I saw students with **raw speed**, courage and curiosity."

Meaning in this passage

Here, **raw speed** means **natural speed that is already clearly present but has not yet been fully developed, refined, or shaped through advanced training**.

The students may already be naturally fast, but their technique, conditioning, race strategy, or formal training may still be undeveloped.

繁體中文：

尚未經充分訓練和雕琢，但已明顯顯示出的天然速度和運動潛質

中文翻譯：

> 「.....我看到一些學生擁有**尚未經正式訓練和雕琢、但已十分明顯的天然速度**、勇氣和好奇心。」

raw speed = 未經充分訓練或技術打磨，但天生已具備的突出速度

1. raw — uncooked — 生的；未煮熟的

The most basic physical meaning.

Practice 1

> “Do not eat **raw** chicken.”

「不要吃**未煮熟的生雞肉**。」

Practice 2

> “The fish can be eaten **raw**.”

「這種魚可以**生吃**。」

raw food/meat = 尚未經過烹煮或加熱處理的食物

2. raw — food in its natural uncooked state — 生鮮的；未烹調的

The same core sense applies to foods commonly eaten without cooking.

Practice 3

> “She added **raw** vegetables to the salad.”

「她在沙律中加入了**生的蔬菜**。」

Practice 4

> “Some people prefer eating carrots **raw**.”

「有些人喜歡**生吃紅蘿蔔**。」

Curation note

I would **not** make:

* raw meat

* raw vegetables

* raw fish

three separate meanings.

The core concept is:

> **not cooked**

3. raw — unprocessed / untreated material — 未加工的；未處理的

A major extension.

Practice 5

> “The factory imports **raw** cotton.”

「工廠入口**未加工的原棉**。」

Practice 6

> “The ore must be processed before it can be used.”

> “At this stage, it is still a **raw** material.”

「在這個階段，它仍然是**未經加工的原材料**。」

raw = 尚未經加工、提煉、精製或製造成成品的

This is the core idea behind **raw materials**.

4. raw materials — 原材料；原料

A very important business/manufacturing compound.

Practice 7

> “The company imports **raw materials** from several countries.”

「公司從多個國家入口**原材料**。」

Practice 8

> “Higher raw-material costs increased production expenses.”

「較高的**原料成本**提高了生產開支。」

raw materials = 尚未被加工成製成品、用作生產其他物品的基本材料

5. raw — natural ability not yet developed — 未經雕琢的；天生而尚未培養的

This is the meaning behind your passage.

Practice 9 — Original sense

> “The students had **raw speed**, courage and curiosity.”

「那些學生擁有**尚未經充分訓練但已明顯存在的天然速度**、勇氣和好奇心。」

Practice 10

> “The young athlete has a lot of **raw talent**.”

「這名年輕運動員很有**未經雕琢的天然天分**。」

Practice 11

> “The coach saw raw potential in the teenager.”

「教練在那名少年身上看到了**尚未充分開發的天然潛力**。」

raw ability/talent/potential = 已明顯存在但尚未經訓練、經驗或技術打磨而成熟的天然能力

This is one of the strongest figurative meanings of **raw**.

6. raw talent — 天然天分；未經雕琢的才能

Practice 12

> “Raw talent alone does not guarantee success.”

「單靠**天然天分**並不能保證成功。」

Practice 13

> “Good coaching can turn raw talent into consistent performance.”

「良好的教練指導可以把**未經雕琢的天分**轉化為穩定表現。」

raw talent = 尚未經充分培養、但已顯示出突出潛質的天然能力

7. raw speed / raw power — 原始速度；天然爆發力

In sport and performance contexts, **raw** frequently emphasizes natural physical capacity.

Practice 14

> “He relies heavily on **raw power**.”

「他很依賴自身的**天然爆發力 / 純粹力量**。」

Practice 15

> “Her raw speed makes her difficult to catch.”

「她的**天然速度 / 純速度能力**令其他人很難追上。」

raw speed/power = 尚未經技巧修飾或策略轉化，本身已經非常突出的純粹身體能力

8. raw — data/information not yet processed — 原始的；未整理的

A major modern academic, business, and technology meaning.

Practice 16

> “The researchers first examined the **raw data**.”

「研究人員首先檢視**原始數據**。」

Practice 17

> “The figures shown here are still **raw** and need further analysis.”

「這些數字仍然是**未經整理 / 分析的原始資料**，需要進一步處理。」

raw data/information = 尚未經清理、分析、整理、轉換或解釋的原始資料

9. raw data — 原始數據

Practice 18

> “Raw data can be difficult to interpret without context.”

「沒有背景資料時，**原始數據**可能很難解讀。」

Practice 19

> “The software converts raw data into charts.”

「軟件把**原始數據**轉換成圖表。」

****raw data = 收集後尚未經充分加工、分析或整理的資料****

10. raw score — 原始分數

In testing and statistics, a ****raw score**** is the direct score obtained before conversion or standardisation.

Practice 20

> “Her ****raw score**** was converted into a percentile.”

「她的****原始分數****被轉換成百分位數。」

Practice 21

> “The raw score alone does not show how the student performed relative to others.”

「單看****原始分數****並不能顯示學生相對其他人的表現。」

****raw score = 尚未轉換、標準化或調整的直接得分****

11. raw footage — 未剪輯片段；原始影片素材

A very common media term.

Practice 22

> “The editor reviewed several hours of ****raw footage****.”

「剪接師檢視了數小時的****未剪輯原始影片素材****。」

Practice 23

> “The documentary used raw footage from the event.”

「紀錄片使用了活動的**原始拍攝片段**。」

****raw footage = 拍攝後尚未經剪接、後期製作或整理的影像素材****

12. raw image / RAW file — 原始影像；RAW 檔案

In digital photography, ****RAW**** often refers to image data recorded with minimal processing.

Practice 24

> “Professional photographers often shoot in ****RAW****.”

「專業攝影師經常使用 ****RAW 原始影像格式**** 拍攝。」

Practice 25

> “A RAW file contains more original image information than a heavily processed image.”

「****RAW 檔案**** 保留了比高度處理影像更多的原始影像資訊。」

****RAW image/file = 相機保留大量原始感光資料、尚未經完整影像處理的檔案****

Capitalisation note

In photography/software contexts, ****RAW**** is frequently written in capitals, though technically it is not necessarily an acronym.

13. raw — skin physically sore/exposed — 擦痛的；破損疼痛的

Another genuinely distinct physical meaning.

Practice 26

> “The shoes rubbed my heels ****raw****.”

「鞋子把我的腳跟磨得****破皮疼痛****。」

Practice 27

> “His hands were red and **raw** from the cold.”

「他的雙手因寒冷而又紅又**疼痛粗糙**。」

raw skin = 因摩擦、寒冷或刺激而變得破損、紅腫、敏感或疼痛的皮膚

14. rub something raw — 磨破；擦傷

A common construction.

Practice 28

> “The strap rubbed her shoulder **raw**.”

「帶子把她的肩膀**磨破了皮**。」

Practice 29

> “Hours of running had rubbed his feet raw.”

「長時間跑步把他的腳**磨得破皮疼痛**。」

rub + body part + raw = 因反覆摩擦令皮膚變得破損、敏感和疼痛

15. raw — emotion/grief/pain that is intense and fresh — 強烈而未平復的；赤裸直接的

A major figurative meaning.

Practice 30

> “The interview was filled with **raw emotion**.”

「這次訪問充滿了**強烈而毫不掩飾的真實情感**。」

Practice 31

> “Her grief was still **raw**.”

「她的悲痛仍然**非常強烈，而且尚未平復**。」

raw emotion/grief = 情緒仍然非常直接、強烈、未被時間或自我控制平復的

The metaphor is similar to ****raw skin****:

> exposed, sensitive, not yet healed.

16. raw emotion — 真情流露；強烈直接的情感

Practice 32

> “The film captures the raw emotion of the athletes after defeat.”

「電影捕捉了運動員落敗後****毫不掩飾的強烈情緒****。」

Practice 33

> “Her speech was full of raw emotion.”

「她的演說充滿了****強烈而真實的情感****。」

17. raw — emotionally sensitive / painful — 尚未平復的；一觸即痛的

Practice 34

> “The argument was still a ****raw**** subject for him.”

「那場爭吵對他來說仍是一個****一提起便感到痛苦的敏感話題****。」

Practice 35

> “The memory was too raw to discuss.”

「那段記憶帶來的痛苦仍然****太新、太強烈****，難以談論。」

****raw subject/memory = 情感傷痛尚未恢復，因此仍然非常敏感的****

18. raw — inexperienced / untrained — 缺乏經驗的；未受充分訓練的

Used especially of recruits, beginners, or newly formed groups.

Practice 36

> “The team contained several **raw** young players.”

「隊中有幾名**經驗不足、尚未成熟的**年輕球員。」

Practice 37

> “He was a raw recruit with little practical experience.”

「他是一名**缺乏實際經驗的新手**。」

raw person/recruit = 尚未經充分訓練、實戰或經驗磨練，因此仍顯生嫩的

This is closely connected to **raw talent**, but the emphasis changes:

* raw talent → strong ability not yet developed

* raw recruit → person lacking experience

19. raw recruit — 新兵；毫無經驗的新手

Practice 38

> “The army turned raw recruits into disciplined soldiers.”

「軍隊把**缺乏訓練的新兵**培養成有紀律的士兵。」

Practice 39

> “The department hired several raw recruits straight from university.”

「部門聘請了幾名剛大學畢業、**缺乏工作經驗的新人**。」

raw recruit = 剛加入而仍未經充分訓練 / 實際經驗磨練的人

20. raw — harsh/cold/damp weather — 寒冷刺骨而潮濕的

A useful weather sense, especially in British English.

Practice 40

> “It was a **raw** winter morning.”

「那是一個**寒冷刺骨而潮濕難受的**冬日早晨。」

Practice 41

> “A raw wind blew across the field.”

「一陣**寒冷刺骨的**風吹過田野。」

raw weather/wind = 寒冷、潮濕而令人身體感到非常不舒服的天氣 / 風

This cannot be translated as “生的天氣”.

21. raw — crude / direct / unpolished style — 粗糙直接的；未經修飾的

Practice 42

> “The recording has a **raw** sound.”

「這段錄音帶有一種**粗獷、未經過度修飾的聲音質感**。」

Practice 43

> “Fans liked the band's raw early style.”

「樂迷喜歡樂隊早期那種**粗獷、直接而未經精緻修飾的風格**。」

raw style/sound = 未經大量修飾、加工或精緻化，因此顯得直接、粗獷或真實的

This can be positive.

22. raw — explicit / unfiltered — 直接而未經過濾的

Practice 44

> “The documentary gives a **raw** account of life after the disaster.”

「這部紀錄片以**直接而毫不粉飾的方式**呈現災後生活。」

Practice 45

> “The book offers a raw description of his experiences.”

「這本書對他的經歷作出**毫不修飾、非常直接的描述**。」

****raw account/description = 沒有被過度美化、過濾或包裝的直接呈現****

23. raw sewage — 未處理污水

A very established environmental compound.

Practice 46

> “The river was polluted by ****raw sewage****.”

「河流受到****未經處理的污水****污染。」

Practice 47

> “Raw sewage must not be discharged into the sea.”

「****未處理污水****不得直接排入海中。」

****raw sewage = 尚未經污水處理程序處理的生活 / 工業污水****

24. raw milk — 未經巴士德消毒的生乳

Practice 48

> “The cheese is made from ****raw milk****.”

「這種芝士以****未經巴士德消毒的生乳****製成。」

Practice 49

> “Rules concerning raw milk vary by jurisdiction.”

「不同地區對****未經巴士德消毒的生乳****有不同規定。」

****raw milk = 未經巴士德消毒或同類熱處理的牛奶 / 乳品原料****

This is more precise than simply “uncooked milk.”

25. raw deal — 不公平待遇；吃虧

A common fixed expression.

Practice 50

> “The workers felt they had received a **raw deal**.”

「工人覺得自己受到了**不公平待遇 / 吃了虧**。」

Practice 51

> “Small businesses sometimes get a raw deal under the system.”

「小型企業在這個制度下有時會受到**不公平對待**。」

get a raw deal = 被不公平對待、得到比合理情況差很多的結果

This meaning is not predictable from **raw = uncooked**.

26. touch a raw nerve — 觸及痛處；碰到敏感點

A very useful fixed expression.

Practice 52

> “His comment **touched a raw nerve**.”

「他的評論**觸及了對方的痛處 / 敏感點**。」

Practice 53

> “The discussion touched a raw nerve among former athletes.”

「這場討論觸及了退役運動員的一個**敏感痛處**。」

touch/hit a raw nerve = 提到某個非常敏感、容易引起強烈情緒的問題

The image comes from a physically exposed, painfully sensitive nerve.

27. raw nerve — 敏感痛點；尚未平復的情緒傷口

Practice 54

> “The issue remains a **raw nerve** within the organisation.”

「這個問題仍然是機構內的一個**敏感痛點**。」

Practice 55

> “Mentioning the failed project hit a raw nerve.”

「提到那個失敗項目**觸及了敏感痛處**。」

28. rawness — 生澀 / 粗獷 / 強烈未平復的狀態

Rawness is the noun form, but its exact Chinese meaning depends heavily on context.

A. physical soreness

> “The cream reduced the **rawness** of the skin.”

「這種藥膏減輕了皮膚的**紅腫敏感和疼痛**。」

B. emotional intensity

> “The **rawness** of his grief was obvious.”

「他悲痛中那種**尚未平復的強烈感**非常明顯。」

C. unpolished artistic quality

> “The recording retains the **rawness** of the live performance.”

「錄音保留了現場表演那種**粗獷直接、未經過度修飾的質感**。」

rawness = 處於未經處理、未平復、未精緻化或高度敏感狀態的特質

Important distinctions

raw vs uncooked

uncooked

specifically means:

> not cooked

raw

can mean that, but is much broader:

- * raw meat
- * raw data
- * raw talent
- * raw emotion
- * raw skin
- * raw materials

So **uncooked** can replace **raw** only in food contexts.

raw vs fresh

raw

= not cooked / not processed

fresh

= recently produced, collected, prepared, or not stale

A vegetable can be:

> fresh and cooked

or:

> fresh and raw

They describe different properties.

raw vs natural

natural

means occurring in nature or not artificial.

raw

means not yet processed, developed, refined, or treated.

Something natural is not necessarily raw.

Something raw may still have undergone some handling.

raw vs unprocessed

These overlap strongly.

unprocessed

precisely means no or little processing has occurred.

raw

can add broader ideas such as:

- * crude
- * undeveloped
- * exposed
- * intense
- * unpolished

> raw emotion

cannot naturally be replaced with:

> unprocessed emotion

raw talent vs talent

talent

= strong ability

raw talent

= strong ability that is clearly visible **but still undeveloped**

So **raw** contributes:

> **not yet refined through training or experience**

This is directly relevant to your sports passage.

raw talent vs potential

raw talent

ability is already visibly present

potential

future capacity may exist even before strong performance is visible

A coach may identify potential before the athlete has demonstrated much raw talent.

raw vs inexperienced

When describing a person:

inexperienced

simply means lacking experience

raw

often means:

> inexperienced, unpolished and not yet fully trained

So **raw** is more vivid and can suggest that development is still needed.

raw data vs information

raw data

unprocessed observations, measurements, records, values

information

data that has typically been organised or interpreted sufficiently to convey meaning

The boundary is not absolute, but the distinction is useful.

raw data vs processed data

raw data

before cleaning/transformation/analysis

processed data

after some operations have been performed

This distinction is especially common in:

- * research
- * analytics
- * computing
- * science

raw footage vs finished video

raw footage

unedited recorded material

finished video

selected, edited, arranged, and usually post-processed content

raw emotion vs genuine emotion

genuine emotion

focuses on sincerity:

> genuinely felt, not fake

raw emotion

focuses on:

> intensity, exposure, lack of restraint or emotional processing

An emotion can be genuine without being raw.

raw vs crude

They can overlap.

raw

often means unprocessed/unrefined

crude

often emphasizes roughness, lack of sophistication, or offensiveness

> raw data ✓

> crude data ⚠ different nuance

> crude joke ✓

> raw joke ⚠ not normally equivalent

raw vs rough

rough

can mean uneven, harsh, imprecise, or unfinished

raw

focuses more on being:

* untreated

* undeveloped

* unrefined

* exposed

A draft can be **rough**, while data is often **raw**.

Family-extension sweep

After the full food, material, sporting, data, media, physical, emotional, environmental, technical, fixed-expression, and second-pass audit, the useful modern family includes:

- * **raw — uncooked** = 生的 / 未煮熟的
- * **raw — unprocessed material** = 未加工的
- * **raw materials** = 原材料
- * **raw talent** = 未經雕琢的天然天分
- * **raw speed/power** = 天然速度 / 純粹爆發力
- * **raw data** = 原始數據
- * **raw score** = 原始分數
- * **raw footage** = 未剪輯原始素材
- * **RAW file/image** = 原始影像檔
- * **raw skin** = 破損、紅腫、敏感疼痛的皮膚
- * **rub something raw** = 磨破皮膚
- * **raw emotion** = 強烈而未經掩飾的情感
- * **raw grief/pain** = 尚未平復的強烈悲痛 / 痛苦
- * **raw subject/memory** = 一觸即痛的敏感話題 / 記憶
- * **raw recruit** = 缺乏訓練的新手 / 新兵
- * **raw weather/wind** = 寒冷刺骨而潮濕的
- * **raw style/sound** = 粗獷直接、未經修飾的
- * **raw account** = 毫不粉飾的直接描述
- * **raw sewage** = 未處理污水
- * **raw milk** = 未經巴士德消毒的生乳
- * **raw deal** = 不公平待遇
- * **raw nerve** = 敏感痛點
- * **touch/hit a raw nerve** = 觸及痛處
- * **rawness** = 未處理 / 未平復 / 粗獷直接的狀態或特質

I would stop there. There are narrower specialist uses in computing, engineering, audio, manufacturing, and particular food movements, but the above gets very close to the useful modern learner-relevant ceiling without turning the entry into a specialist dictionary dump.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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raw — food	尚未經烹煮或加熱處理的
raw — material	尚未經加工、提煉、精製或製造成成品的
raw materials	用來生產其他物品、尚未加工成製成品的基本材料

raw talent/ability	已顯示突出能力，但尚未經充分訓練、經驗或技術打磨的天然天分	
raw speed/power	尚未依靠高階技巧修飾，本身已非常突出的天然速度 / 力量	
raw data	尚未經清理、分析、整理或轉換的原始資料	
raw score	尚未被換算、標準化或調整的直接得分	
raw footage	拍攝後尚未經剪接或後期製作的原始影像素材	
RAW image/file	保留大量原始感光資訊、尚未經完整影像處理的數碼檔案	
raw skin	因摩擦、寒冷或刺激而變得破損、敏感和疼痛的	
raw emotion	強烈、直接而尚未被控制或平復的情感	
raw grief/pain	情緒傷痛仍非常強烈、尚未被時間平復的	
raw subject/memory	因情緒傷痛尚未恢復而非常敏感、一提起便感到痛苦的	
raw recruit/person	缺乏訓練、實戰或經驗，因此仍顯生嫩的新人	
raw weather/wind	寒冷、潮濕而令人感到刺骨難受的	
raw style/sound	未經大量加工或修飾，因此顯得粗獷、直接而真實的	
raw account	沒有過度美化、過濾或包裝的直接描述	
raw sewage	尚未經污水處理程序處理的污水	
raw milk	尚未經巴士德消毒等熱處理的乳品	
raw deal	明顯不公平、令某人吃虧的待遇	
raw nerve	容易引起痛苦、憤怒或強烈情緒的敏感問題	
touch a raw nerve	提到某個非常敏感、會立即引起強烈情緒的痛處	
rawness	未經處理、未平復、未精緻化或高度敏感的狀態 / 特質	

For your original sentence

> “...students with ****raw speed****, courage and curiosity.”

The exact meaning is:

****raw** = 已經自然存在並相當突出，但尚未經充分正式訓練、技巧調整和長期發展而成熟的******

Therefore:

****raw speed** = 尚未經正式訓練和技術打磨，但已明顯展現出的天然速度******

A particularly natural Traditional Chinese rendering would be:

> ****「天生而尚未經雕琢的速度潛質」****

or more simply:

> ****「未經雕琢的天然速度」****

The passage is ****not**** using the food meaning “生的”; it is using the figurative ****undeveloped/unrefined natural ability**** sense.